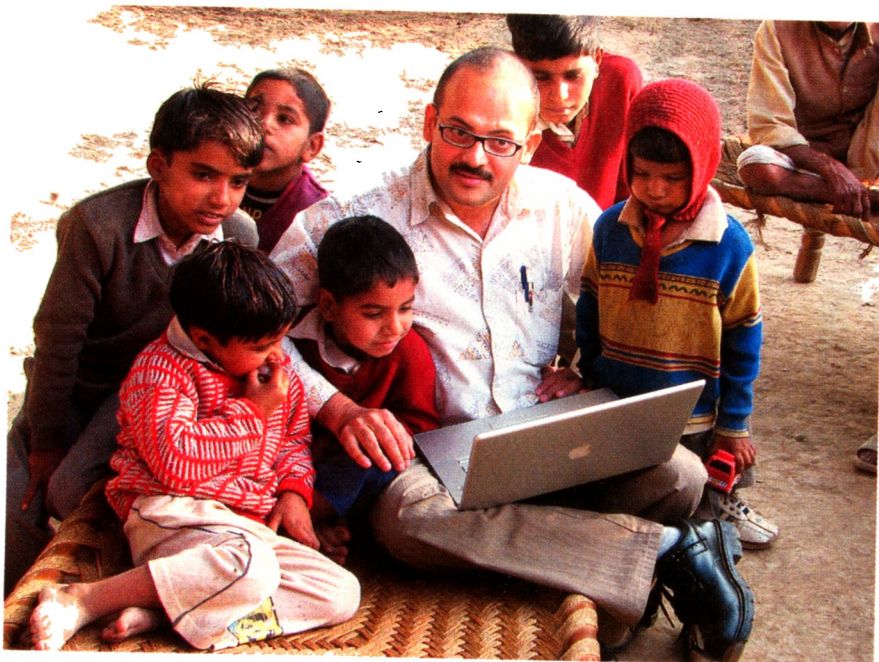




WEB VISION: Drishtee's ICT network is the brainchild of Satyan Mishra

momentum over a period of time. The Schwab Foundation for Social Entrepreneurship, also founded by Schwab, has launched its annual 'Social Entrepreneur of the Year in India' competition in association with the Nand and Jeet Khemka Foundation

(NJKF) to provide a platform for entrepreneurs to showcase their ventures and identify prospective investors. The Schwab Foundation also facilitates linkages with captains of industry and political leaders through events like the India Economic Summit.

Says 32-year-old Sweta Mangal of 1298 Dial for Ambulance, which aims to make ambulance services accessible to all: "Such awards and events are important to us as they give us an opportunity to meet other entrepreneurs and get inputs from global bodies." This new army of social entrepreneurs is gaining voice, with funding from venture capitalists and recognition from institutions like WEF, which has instituted an award for social entrepreneurship in association with NJKF. Uday Khemka, managing trustee of NJKF, describes social entrepreneurs as innovators and pragmatic visionaries who achieve large scale social transformation through the development and delivery of new products and services. This wave has surely caught on in India, with doctors and bankers trying to create institutions that engender social change. Be it developing low-cost irrigation systems or providing financial services to the urban poor, such businesses not only serve the masses but also manage to make profit. This might just be the right mantra for social change today. ■

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